

Where does the US get the land, water, and power to run the AI data centers that have been authorized to be built?

Posted by u/DrAmsterdam • • 0 points • 2 comments

I saw that there were like 600+ in VA alone? How much do these things require in terms of resources (water, power etc) and where does it come from?

Comments

u/XRuecian • 2 points • 2026-01-01 14:50 UTC

You are vastly underestimating just how much unused land the US has. There is a reason why when you drive on the interstate its just hours of road and forest with no civilization in site sometimes. Space isn't an issue.

We could move the *entire* population of the US into Texas and it would only be slightly more densely populated than India.

The US is one of the least densely populated countries on the planet. And one of the largest countries via landmass. Put those together and you end up with... a lot of unused land.

u/Green_Goblin13 • 1 points • 2026-01-01 13:36 UTC

The US uses natural gas for about 43% of its electricity generation, while around 18% comes from nuclear. So it's not like renewables are the only thing in the mix.